

JENSON NELSON

PRODUCTION ARTIST · APPAREL GRAPHICS · COLOR DESIGN

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PROFILE

Apparel graphic designer and production artist with 14 years of experience taking artwork from concept to factory-ready files for tees, cut-and-sew apparel, and high-volume consumer products. I focus on clean vector construction, accurate separations and colorways, garment placement and scale, and clear vendor documentation. I draw and paint by hand, build repeats and allover prints, and carry color from palette through sample approval. I manage concurrent seasonal projects with cross-functional partners and international vendors.

CORE EXPERTISE

Production Art: production-ready Illustrator files and apparel graphic schematics · laydowns and placement specs · artwork construction and file organization · separations and colorways · tracking file updates through final approval · documentation for downstream partners

Graphic Application: screen print, allover print, sublimation, patches, and heat transfers · seamless repeats and engineered placements · scale, layout, and placement on garments · trim and label callouts · ink and substrate awareness · sample and strike-off review with vendors

Color Design: palette building and color theory · seasonal color stories · colorways and color blocking · CMF (color, material, finish) · color accuracy across vendors · trend translation

Apparel and Product: tees and cut-and-sew graphics · tech packs, flats, and graded specs · PLM and SAP · approval gates · international vendor communication · product lifecycle from brief to shelf

Tools and Collaboration: Adobe Illustrator and Photoshop (advanced) · CLO 3D and 3D visualization · InDesign · Acrobat · Figma · Miro · Airtable · AI-assisted design tools · cross-functional work with apparel design, graphic design, technical design, development, and merchandising

SELECTED APPAREL GRAPHIC WORK

Jordan Holiday Knit, Jacquard Sweater, Self-Initiated | Portland, OR | 2026

- Developed a knit-in jacquard motif with a three-yarn color story, matched pattern bands, and rib trim, documented as a production-ready tech pack.
- Delivered flats, schematics, colorways, material specs, construction rules, graded measurements from S to 3XL, BOM, and approval gates for vendor handoff.

INDUSTRY, Self-Initiated Print and Pattern Capsule, Concept | Portland, OR | 2026

- Built three original seamless repeats from hospitality source material: a guest check grid, a floor path system, and a service language ticket rail, each drawn by hand and rebuilt as a clean, production-ready repeat tile.
- Developed three colorways (Oven, Walk-in, Service Black) with a documented palette and a pattern sheet showing every repeat, colorway, and tonal value together.
- Applied the prints to tees, aprons, and hats in allover and placement applications, sized and scaled per garment so the repeat reads correctly on the body.
- Structured the capsule as one print engine a restaurant group can order in volume, with a second season that recolors rather than redraws.

Nike Women's Fall, Seasonal Color and Apparel Concept, Self-Initiated | Portland, OR | 2025

- Developed a seasonal apparel and footwear concept through cultural research, moodboards, palette building, and graphic direction.

- Built a fall palette of black, slate, peach, blush, warm stone, and taupe with a cool seafoam accent, then carried it across apparel graphics and footwear colorway application.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Graphic and Product Designer, Freelance and Studio, Own Studio | Portland, OR | 2020 to Present

- Design apparel graphics, prints, packaging, and brand systems for independent brands, agencies, and retail clients, owning work from research through production-ready handoff.
- Founded and run a private label brand: product graphics, print application, packaging, and e-commerce across Shopify, Etsy, and Amazon, sourcing through marketing.
- Directed the full brand system for Nostos International Grocery, spanning logo, palette, typography, packaging, signage, uniforms, and materials built to flex across regions and formats.
- Led the strategic rebrand of CT Defense into Modus, delivering name, mark, investor deck, collateral, vehicle wraps, and signage. The identity anchored a raise of \$1.2M in private funding within two months.
- Led end-to-end creation of a luxury candle line sold through Costco, IKEA, TJX, and Safeway, designing vessels, scents, lids, and labels while managing international vendors on quality and delivery.

Senior Graphic and Product Designer, 99 Cents Only Stores | Commerce, CA | 2017 to 2020

- Designed seasonal product, graphics, and packaging across apparel, accessories, toys, beauty, and home, building trend-driven graphic systems informed by color forecasting and cultural insight.
- Generated \$19.83M in 2019 category sales with a 21% year-over-year growth forecast, across hundreds of SKUs a year on a tight seasonal calendar.
- Owned artwork from concept through production: trend research, product and print development, buyer and vendor review, sample approval, and production files.
- Managed international vendor communication on timelines, specs, and production files, cutting turnaround by 25% without sacrificing quality.
- Partnered with merchandising and sourcing through PLM and SAP to align design intent with pricing and manufacturing constraints.

Art Director and Graphic Designer, 1933 Group | Los Angeles, CA | December 2014 to July 2016

- Built venue brand systems for a Los Angeles hospitality group: menus, coasters, table tents, window vinyl, signage, and merch graphics, each tuned to the personality of its space.
- Ran seasonal rollouts end to end, preparing printer-ready files and coordinating screen and offset vendors to hit fixed go-live dates across multiple venues.
- Shaped the visual language for venues including Highland Park Bowl and Idle Hour, work that still runs on menus, merch, and signage in those rooms.

Graphic and Product Designer, Production Artist, American Apparel | Los Angeles, CA | 2012 to 2014

- Designed brand, retail, product-facing, and campaign creative for an iconic Los Angeles apparel brand, working in graphics, color, layout, and fast-turn fashion retail.
- Produced production-ready apparel graphic files, colorways, and layouts for high-volume seasonal collections, holding brand consistency across a fast-turn cycle.
- Kept fit standards and measurement spec sheets current and communicated updates to production teams and domestic vendors, moving concepts from brief to production-ready handoff.

EDUCATION AND BEYOND DESIGN

California State University, Long Beach · Interdisciplinary Studies coursework

Exhibited painter · Regional Arts and Culture Council, Community Grant Reviewer for Visual Arts, Design and Cultural Arts (2023 to 2024) · CoachArt Visual Arts Coach (2022) · Community School of the Arts Foundation, Volunteer Designer (2020 to 2022)